



House of Marley Stir it Up Turntable

A melodious marvel for the price

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In a world where technology often prioritises convenience over quality, the resurgence of vinyl records has rekindled a passion for analogue sound. This renewed interest in vinyl has led to a proliferation of turntables, each catering to different tastes, from the casual listener to the audiophile. Among these, the House of Marley Stir It Up Turntable stands out, not just for its sound quality but for its commitment to sustainability and stylish design.

After having played around with the House of Marley Stir it Up Turntable, here my thoughts about the features, performance, and overall experience of using it.

Design and Build Quality

The first thing that strikes you about the House of Marley Stir It Up Turn-

table is its design. This turntable is an aesthetic masterpiece, blending modern minimalism with a touch of retro charm. The bamboo plinth is not only visually appealing but also aligns with the brand's commitment to sustainability. The use of bamboo, a rapidly renewable resource, highlights the eco-friendly ethos that House of Marley is known for. This choice of material gives the turntable a warm, natural look that sets it apart from the usual plastic and metal designs found in many other turntables.

The plinth is complemented by a metal tonearm and a fabric dust cover, which is made from the brand's signature REWIND fabric, composed of recycled materials. The attention to detail is evident in every aspect of the design, from the sleek aluminium alloy platter to the discreet Marley branding.

The overall build quality is solid, with a reassuring heft that suggests durability. The Stir It Up Turntable is a piece of equipment that not only looks good in your living room but also feels like it will stand the test of time.

One minor critique could be that the fabric dust cover, while attractive, might not offer the same level of protection as a traditional hardcover. It's a trade-off between aesthetics and practicality, but one that many users will likely find acceptable, given the overall design appeal.

Sound Quality

When it comes to sound quality, the House of Marley Stir It Up Turntable delivers a performance that belies its mid-range price point. The Audio-Technica cartridge provides a warm, rich sound that is characteristic of vinyl. The bass response is deep and well-defined without overwhelming the mids and highs. Vocals come through with clarity and presence, while instruments are rendered with a pleasing level of detail. The overall sound signature leans slightly towards the warm side, which is typical of many analogue setups, but this is likely to be appreciated by those who prefer a more vintage sound.

The aluminium alloy platter contributes to the turntable's sound quality by providing a stable, low-resonance platform for the records. This helps to minimise vibrations and ensure a consistent speed, both of which are crucial for accurate sound reproduction. The result is a smooth, engaging listening experience that captures the essence of vinyl.

However, it's worth noting that the built-in preamp, while convenient, may not satisfy audiophiles who demand the highest level of sound fidelity. For those users, bypassing the internal preamp and using a higher-end external one could yield better results. That said, for the average listener, the built-in preamp should be more than sufficient, delivering a sound that is full-bodied and enjoyable.